THE OLD HABITS CLUB — FREE GUIDE

The Evidence *Cheat-Sheet*

21 everyday Indian habits, each checked against real research and given one honest label. No hype, no guesswork — every line below is backed by a source we opened ourselves. Full write-ups, sources and try-it steps: see the book *Steel Plates & Clay Pots* or our habit library.

Well supported
Good studies or reviews back this specific claim.

Some evidence
Small trials or observational studies point this way, but don't settle it.

Tradition, not yet proven
Widely valued, often harmless — but research hasn't confirmed the health claim.

HABIT	WHAT THE LABEL ACTUALLY COVERS
Clay pot water	Well supported for cooling, via evaporation. Tradition for "purifying" or detox claims.
Steel thali	A practical, easy-to-clean choice — tradition, not yet proven as a health upgrade over other plates.
Eating with hands	Some evidence that eating slowly helps; tradition, not yet proven for hands specifically "triggering" digestion.
Ghee on roti	Some evidence it raises cholesterol markers more than olive oil. Tradition for gut/immunity claims.
Walking barefoot	Some evidence it changes gait. Tradition for posture, balance, "grounding".
Morning sunlight	Some evidence for sleep timing. Well supported for sun-safety limits. Tradition for vitamin D claims.
Walk after meals	Well supported for a short-term drop in post-meal blood sugar. Tradition for "aiding digestion".
Sitting on the floor	Some evidence linking rising-from-floor ability to longevity. Tradition for floor-sitting itself.
Iron kadhai	Some evidence it adds iron to food. Tradition for curing anaemia.
Curd & chaas	Well supported for easing lactose intolerance (live-culture yogurt). Tradition that home curd is "probiotic".
Haldi doodh	Some evidence for concentrated curcumin extracts in knee pain. Tradition for a glass of turmeric milk.
Ginger & tulsi tea	Some evidence for ginger and pregnancy nausea. Tradition for tulsi.
Slow breathing	Some evidence for calm and small blood-pressure changes. Tradition for specific pranayama techniques.
Surya Namaskar	Well supported for BP, cholesterol, weight vs. no exercise. Some evidence for back pain, anxiety.
Oil massage (abhyanga)	Some evidence for relaxation and skin moisture. Tradition for "removing toxins" or lymph drainage.
Oil pulling	Some evidence for short-term fresher breath. Tradition for cavities, whitening, "detox".
Soaked foods & spices	Some evidence for fennel-cumin-ajwain blends easing dyspepsia. Tradition that soaking "activates" nutrients.

HABIT	WHAT THE LABEL ACTUALLY COVERS
Copper vessel water	**Well supported** that copper kills bacteria in stored water (lab). **Well supported** that too much copper is harmful.
Eating with the seasons	A practical choice for cost and freshness — **tradition, not yet proven** that seasonal produce is more nutritious.
Early dinner	**Some evidence** for metabolic and reflux benefits, from small/observational studies.
Wind-down routine	**Well supported** for consistent sleep routines. **Some evidence** for the specific effect of screens.

Educational content, not medical advice. If you have a health condition, take medicines, or are pregnant, talk to your doctor before changing your diet or routine. Every claim above is sourced — full citations in the book and on the website.